Program Name:	Rainbow DJ Lab: Teen DJ Apprenticeship	Dates:	February - May 2027
Session:	Spring 2027	Number of Weeks:	11 (10 + showcase week)

Daily Structure/Program Flow

Having **Ritual or Routine** during each day allows teens to know what to expect walking in a room. This can support a safe environment and encourage teens to lead activities!

- Post Daily Agenda (Schedule) with clear objectives or goals for the day!
- Agenda/Schedule can be modified as needed; Incorporate teen voice and choice!
- Daily rituals and routines: structured opening (Icebreakers/Community Builders) and closing activities (Daily reflection that can include individual journaling, group conversation, talking in pairs, etc.)
- Identify MHA skills being worked on for the day (Personal Mindset, Planning for Success, Social Awareness, Communication, Collaboration and Problem Solving).
- Plan for back-up lesson plans.
- Materials and supplies readily available to begin all activities.
- Post Signage (Inclusivity, Program Schedule).
- Taking daily attendance; sign in and sign-out)
- Set up daily clean- up time; incorporate teen in activity.

Please identify **Teen Ambassador (s)** to welcome visitors/guests. Having a teen welcome a visitor/guests not only provides a leadership opportunity for a teen but also allows instructor to teach without interruption.

- Identify teen leads / teen ambassadors for the day/session.
- Opportunities for youth to lead community building activities, planned activities or serve as peer mentors.
- Back up teens welcomed to step up for leadership opportunity.

Activate selected program **Teen Assistants**; allow for leadership opportunities to support with icebreakers, community builders, reflections, etc.

Include establishing **Group Agreements (Norms and Expectations)** on the first day of program!

- Review at the start of each program day!
- Live document: make modifications as needed.
- Incorporate feedback from youth!
- Display in your program space in a visible location!
- Teen buy-in by having teens sign/initial the bottom half of the group agreements created.

Teen Engagement can relate to teen attendance, sense of belonging and shared control of the space/program.

- Planning for diverse types of work, learning styles, and activities (group, individual, pairs).
- Incorporating youth choice and voice into daily activities!
- Be mindful of different learning styles (Visual, auditory, physical, verbal, combination).
- Stay flexible as a facilitator; check and read the room temperature. Adapt when needed!
- The environment is set up to be both physically and emotionally safe for all to learn, work and interact with each other.

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Overall Program Goal

Program Mission: Briefly describe your program and what you hope to achieve.

Rainbow DJ Lab, a Ras Tafari Inc. program at Rainbow Beach Park, turns Chicago high school teens (ages 14-18) into working DJs. Teens learn the craft of DJing, the history behind the music and the business of gigging, and build confidence, discipline and teamwork behind the decks. Every teen leaves able to plan, play and promote a set for a real crowd, and sees a path into music, media and event careers.

Skills Building

Teens independently use their learning to…

(Describe what teens will be able to demonstrate in the final event/showcase; should be relevant and/or relate to life outside program)

Plan, rehearse and perform a 10-15 minute themed DJ set at a teen-run public showcase at Rainbow Beach Park. Teens run the sound check, MC for each other, promote the event with their own DJ name, logo and flyer, and leave with a recorded mix and a one-page portfolio they can use to book real gigs.

Skill Purpose

MHA Skills Needed to Accomplish Mission:

(Personal Mindset, Planning for Success, Social Awareness, Verbal Communication, Collaboration, Problem Solving)

Personal Mindset: practicing until a blend is clean; mistakes are called "Data!" and retried without shame.
Planning for Success: weekly Passport goals; building a set list and timeline for the showcase.
Social Awareness: reading a crowd; respecting each culture's music in our genre rotation.
Verbal Communication: MC practice, introducing a set, explaining a song's history in Crate Dig.
Collaboration: pair coaching at the decks; showcase crew roles (selector, MC, sound tech, promo).
Problem Solving: rescuing a mix live, troubleshooting sound, adjusting a set when the floor goes cold.

Teens will understand that…

(Address the big ideas of your program; should also anticipate teens misconceptions)

DJing is a craft and a business, not just pressing play. Common misconception: "the software does it all." Teens learn why beatmatching, phrasing and reading a room still matter. Every genre has a history, many of them Black and Chicago-born (house, footwork), and a DJ carries that history. Respect for the crowd, the gear and each other is part of the job.

College and Career Readiness

Teens will know…

(What college and career resources will teens acquire as a result of this program).

Paths into DJing, audio engineering, music business and event production; local studios, venues and college music programs; how to price a gig and read a simple contract.

Teens will be skilled at…

(What activities will teens perform to prepare for college/career).

Beatmatching and EQ blends; building and recording a set; PA setup and sound checks; MC and public speaking; writing a DJ bio and making a flyer.

Youth Feedback & Reflection

- (List an important quality that comes from youth feedback and reflection)

Teen voice drives the music: teens vote on genres and Theme Clash prompts, give each other one "fire" and one "fix," and log progress in their Passport. Weekly exit tickets shape the next lesson.

PERFORMANCE TASK(S):

(Describe an activity that will be used to assess teens).

Weekly Spotlight: each teen plays a 3-5 minute mix for the room and gets peer and instructor feedback on a simple rubric (transitions, energy, crowd reading). Final assessment: a 10-15 minute themed set at the public showcase, plus a recorded mix and portfolio, scored on the same rubric to show growth since Week 1.

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Weekly Plan

Non – Program Days

September 26, 2025: CPS Non – Attendance Day

October 13, 2025: Indigenous Peoples Day

October 27, 2025: CPS Parent Teacher Conference (Report Card Pick Up)

October 31, 2025: Halloween Day

November 11, 2025: Veteran's Day

Thanksgiving Break: November 24, 2025 – November 9, 2025

# of Weeks Range Dates	Summary of Activity List plans for the weeks!	Accommodations & Modifications (Describe how diverse learners or various learning styles will be supported).
Week 1 Date Range	Focus: Welcome and foundations. - Group agreements written and signed by teens; teen ambassadors chosen. - Gear care and hearing safety; parts of the controller. - First blend: play two songs back to back. Crate Dig ritual begins.	Visual step cards; written + verbal directions; capped-volume headphones; a quieter station.
Week 2 Date Range	Focus: Beats and phrasing (Black History Month). - Counting bars; beatmatching by ear; phrasing on the 32. - Crate Dig: Chicago house and Frankie Knuckles. - Pair drills: one mixes, one coaches.	Beat grid on screen; peer mentor pairs; extra practice time.
Week 3 Date Range	Focus: EQ, blends and genres. - EQ swaps and filters; clean transitions. - Genre rotation: house, footwork, hip-hop, reggae, Afrobeats, Latin. - Each teen researches one song's history and shares it (Black History Month).	Teens choose genres; lyric sheets; Spanish support.
Week 4 Date Range	Focus: Effects, scratching basics and the Theme Clash. - Effects, loops and scratch basics. - First Theme Clash in pairs: a movie, TV or game theme blended into a hit. - Spotlight with peer feedback.	Adjustable stations; effects-only option instead of scratching.

Week 5 Date Range	Focus: Building a set. - Plan a 10-minute set with an energy arc. - Record a first practice mix. - Mid-session Passport check-in with an instructor.	Set-planning template; one-on-one check-ins.
Week 6 Date Range	Focus: Production. - Build a beat or edit; sampling basics. - Record a DJ intro drop. - MC basics: introducing a set.	Simplified production templates; adaptive mouse and keyboard.
Week 7 Date Range	Focus: Live sound. - PA setup, gain staging, mic technique. - Sound check roles; crowd-reading drills.	Free earplugs; observe first; MC cue cards.
Week 8 Date Range	Focus: The business of DJing. - DJ name, logo, bio and flyer; safe social media. - Pricing a gig; a simple contract. Showcase crews formed.	Fill-in templates; private or public social options.
Week 9 Date Range	Focus: Showcase planning. - Run of show, set lists and promotion (teen-led). - Rehearsal rounds with fire/fix feedback.	Small-group rehearsals; teens choose crew role.
Week 10 Date Range	Focus: Dress rehearsal. - Full run-through; final mixes recorded. - Teen ambassadors prepare to host guests.	Sensory-friendly rehearsal; cue cards.
Week 11 Date Range	Focus: Showcase and reflection. - Teen-run public showcase at Rainbow Beach Park. - Reflection circle, portfolios, feedback survey; next steps (open at Rainbow Wednesdays).	Performing optional (crew roles count); accessible venue; private reflection option.